

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel SIEM | XDR | Detection Engineering | SOAR | KQL

United Kingdom (Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniproper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Extended Detection and Response (XDR), and detection engineering. I specialise in Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) and Microsoft Defender XDR, including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), alongside CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR). I have designed and operationalised detection content mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, built Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to automate incident response workflows, and delivered security telemetry analysis at scale across enterprise environments of 8,000+ users. I bring strong expertise in cloud security via Microsoft Azure and Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory/Azure AD), PowerShell scripting, and security automation, and I hold extensive experience working with Windows and Linux platforms in hybrid and cloud-first environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel, KQL (detection rule authoring, threat hunting, workbooks, analytics), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM
- **XDR:** Microsoft Defender XDR (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/Prevent/Insight/Discover
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection content, alert logic design, telemetry analysis, log source integration
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, Logic Apps, SOAR workflow automation, alert triage automation
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, cloud posture monitoring
- **Scripting:** PowerShell (automation, security tooling, incident response scripts)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, containment, eradication, recovery, post-incident analysis
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM
- **MDM/Identity:** Microsoft Intune, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Azure AD
- **Platforms:** Windows Server and endpoint, Linux environments
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer, University of the Arts, London (UoA) | March 2025 - Present
- Design and develop KQL analytics rules, threat hunting queries, and workbooks aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework to improve threat visibility and detection coverage
 - Develop and operate SOAR playbooks within Microsoft Sentinel to automate incident response workflows, reducing mean time to respond through automated alert triage, enrichment, and containment actions
 - Manage Microsoft Defender XDR across MDE, MDI, and M365 Defender, configuring policies, reviewing telemetry, and leading incident investigation and response activities
 - Operate CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR modules (Prevent, Insight, Discover) for endpoint threat detection, alert triage, and threat hunting across Windows, macOS, and mobile endpoints
 - Integrate and onboard log sources into Microsoft Sentinel, ensuring comprehensive security telemetry coverage across cloud, on-premises, and hybrid infrastructure

- Manage Microsoft Entra ID and Azure AD, configuring Conditional Access policies, MFA, and SSO to enforce Zero Trust access controls across an 8,000-user environment
- Administer Microsoft Intune for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), maintaining device compliance across Windows and mobile endpoints
- Lead incident response activities in alignment with NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK, coordinating cross-functional containment, eradication, and recovery processes
- Conduct vulnerability scanning and security assessments using Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), tracking findings to remediation
- Maintain BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to control and audit access to critical systems
- Manage Check Point Harmony firewall policies and Mimecast email security gateway configurations across the university network
- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulations, driving measurable improvement in staff security behaviours

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity, University of the Arts, London (UAL)
 Managed security monitoring and endpoint protection controls across cloud-hosted Software as a Service (SaaS) infrastructure
March 2022 - March 2025

- Built and maintained SOAR automation logic to streamline alert triage and accelerate response times for common security events
- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, tuning policies, investigating endpoint alerts, and supporting threat hunting activities
- Integrated log telemetry from Microsoft 365, Azure AD, and on-premises systems into Microsoft Sentinel for centralised security monitoring
- Supported Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) operations, configuring policies and responding to XDR alerts
- Administered Azure Active Directory (now Microsoft Entra ID) and Conditional Access policies, enforcing MFA and SSO across the enterprise
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, tracking remediation of identified findings
- Supported incident response investigations, performing log analysis and SIEM-based investigation using KQL
- Contributed to the successful Cyber Essentials+ certification by ensuring detection and monitoring controls met required standards

IT Engineer, Security, Quality and Infrastructure, HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/Fintech)
 Managed security monitoring and endpoint protection controls across cloud-hosted Software as a Service (SaaS) infrastructure
February 2021 - March 2022

- Supported security event monitoring and log analysis using security tooling across Windows and Linux environments
- Administered access management, MFA deployment, and identity provisioning processes
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and supported remediation of identified security risks across internal and cloud-hosted systems
- Contributed to infrastructure quality assurance and security policy implementation

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and operationalised a Microsoft Sentinel SIEM detection framework using KQL, with rules mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, improving detection coverage and reducing false positive rates across the UAL security operations function
- Built SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate triage and response for common alert types, measurably reducing analyst workload and mean time to respond
- Deployed and operationalised CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM across an 8,000-user estate, integrating endpoint telemetry with SIEM and improving threat visibility
- Led the integration of Microsoft Defender XDR (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) into the SIEM detection and response workflow, creating a unified XDR and SIEM operating model

- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials+ certification, demonstrating compliance with robust detection, monitoring, and endpoint protection standards
- Ran Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercises to continuously validate detection coverage and identify gaps in SIEM/XDR telemetry

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)